Jarrod Tran

AI Product & Strategy Leader

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Summary

AI product and strategy leader who builds teams, brings AI tools into daily use, and measures their impact. Experience spans capital allocation at Tesla, engineering planning at Waymo, and market entry at Apple.

Experience

Tesla | Lead, AI Enablement & Factory Strategy | Aug 2023 - Present

Rejoined in 2023 after Apple and Waymo.

- Built and lead an AI product and engineering team that serves 1,000+ active users across 20+ production AI solutions, including RAG troubleshooting, automated reporting, workflow automation, and decision support.
- Set the AI roadmap, adoption metrics, and leadership reporting for an enablement program covering 10,000 employees. Modeled roughly 540 hours reclaimed per week and $1.6M in annualized productivity value.
- Built Python and Tableau models to rank investments by return. Allocated $23M across 50+ initiatives for $156M in incremental annual profit.
- Led the investment roadmap across California, Texas, and Shanghai and scaled Megapack 3.2×. A separate program delivered $260M in annualized savings.
- Mitigated $550M in projected tariff exposure by redesigning the product and investment plan.

Waymo | Strategy & Operations Manager | Oct 2022 - May 2023

- Led annual planning, OKRs, and quarterly business reviews for Engineering Operations. Turned leadership priorities into resource plans, targets, and milestones.
- Aligned six functions on commercial deployment priorities, including safety and regulatory work. Built dashboards for performance, fleet health, and program milestones.

Apple | Strategic Operations Program Manager | Jun 2021 - Jun 2022

- Led the 0-to-1 iPhone launch in India, from market entry and partner qualification through launch readiness and scaled delivery.
- Supported 293% year-over-year growth (4.3M to 16.9M units) and a program whose reported revenue grew from $2B to $10B. Expanded exports from 6 to 40+ countries.

Tesla | Program Manager, Special Projects | Jun 2018 - Jun 2021

- Advanced Project Roadrunner, Tesla's 4680 program, from pilot to launch readiness through Battery Day. Led Model 3 and Model Y planning and recovery.
- Launched Warehouse on Wheels, a $3.5M per month coordination platform that protected product availability during scale-up.

Amazon | Operations Area Manager | Mar 2017 - Apr 2018

- Led 100+ associates in a high-volume fulfillment center.

Education

University at Buffalo | B.S. Business Administration, Finance | Cum Laude